❖ Sandy soil

It contains greater proportion of big particles. They cannot fit closely together. Water can drain quickly through the spaces between the sand particles. So, sandy soils tend to be light, well aerated and dry.

❖ Clay soil

It contains greater proportion of fine particles, packed tightly together, leaving little space for air. It can retain a lot of water in the tiny gaps between the particles. Plants like paddy grow well in this soil.

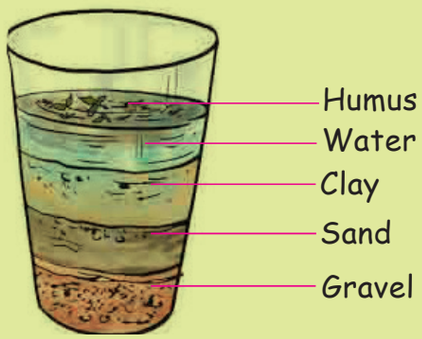
❖ Loamy soil

It contains large and fine particles in almost same proportion. The best top soil for growing plants is loam. It is a mixture of sand, clay and another type of soil particle known as silt. Silt occurs as a deposit in river beds. It has right water holding capacity for the growth of plants. Clay and loamy soil are suitable for growing wheat, gram and paddy.



Activity 5

Take a little amount of soil and powder it. Put this soil in a glass tumbler. Mix it with water; stir it well with a small stick to dissolve the soil. Let it undisturbed for some time. Now you can see different layers of soil. The rotting matter floating on the water is called humus. The other layers are clay, sand and gravel. From this we can see that the soil is a mixture of various particles.



2 Classroom Agriculture

Classroom agriculture creates the basic understanding about agricultural practices in the classes. Through this, we come to know about the values and importance of agriculture. To mould us into better members of the society, this programme teaches the connections between agriculture and the environment, food, energy, animals, society, economy, science and technology.



IV. Friends of Farmer

Insects are generally considered to be harmful. But, many of them are helpful to us in many ways. Earthworm, honeybee and dragonfly are useful to plants and farmers.

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